

Emperor penguin

The life of the world's biggest penguin is a story of surviving extremes. It is one of the very few animals to live and breed on the Antarctic continent—the coldest place on Earth. Emperor penguins raise their chicks in the dark, bitter Antarctic winter, when the temperature can drop to -76°F (-60°C).

Fluffy chicks

Emperor penguin chicks have downy gray feathers. They stay on the ice, dependent on their parents, until they molt into their adult plumage and set off to sea to fish for themselves.

Speedy sliders

Penguins waddle around slowly on land, but they have a way of speeding up—"tobogganing" over snow and ice on their bellies.

ANIMALS IN DANGER

Emperor penguin

⚠️ IUCN status: near threatened

📊 Population estimate: 595,000 in 2009

Keeping warm

Thousands of males huddle together to stay warm in the harsh Antarctic winter. Each is incubating a single egg under his belly, on top of his feet. The males stay on the ice with their egg all winter, until the females return.

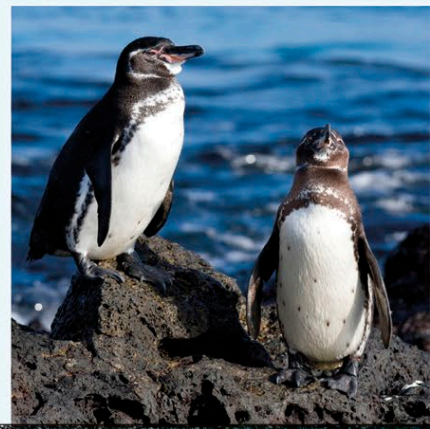


PENGUINS



Galapagos penguin

All 18 species of penguin live in the southern hemisphere. The most northerly one lives on the Galapagos Islands at the equator, nesting in crevices in the volcanic rock.



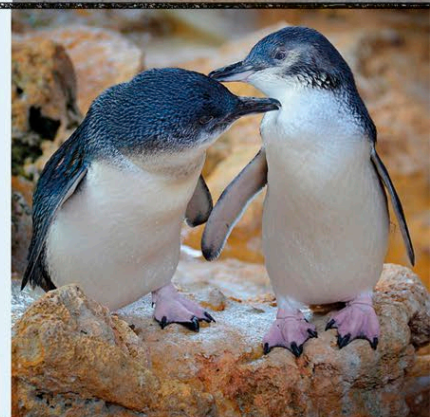
Jackass penguin

The only African penguin nests and feeds mainly on and around offshore islands, but is also sometimes found on the coasts of Namibia and South Africa.



Little penguin

This is the world's smallest penguin, at only 16 in (40 cm) tall. It lives on southern Australian, Tasmanian, and New Zealand coasts, nesting on the dunes.



Macaroni penguin

Like most penguin species, the macaroni penguin lives on islands in the Southern Ocean, between Antarctica and warmer waters further north.



Adélie penguin

The Adélie penguin is the only other penguin species restricted to Antarctica. Unlike the emperor, it breeds on ice-free shores during the summer months.

